TEST SCHOOL

Annual Examination 2026

English

Roll No. ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Time Allowed: 3 hours **Maximum Marks: 100**

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory unless a choice is indicated.
2. Marks for each question are indicated against it.
3. Read each question carefully before answering.
4. Write your answers in the answer booklet provided.
5. Draw neat, labelled diagrams wherever necessary.

SECTION A — OBJECTIVE (20 MARKS)

All questions are compulsory. Each carries 1 mark.

1. Why did Maddie initially fail to notice the face and head of the drawing? **[1]**

(a) The drawing was lying face down on the bed.
(b) The colours in the dress were extremely bright and striking.
(c) Her eyes were blurred with tears while looking at the image.
(d) She was too excited to focus on the portrait's details.

2. What evidence indicated that Mij had struggled inside the box while the narrator was away? **[1]**

(a) The box had been completely destroyed by the animal.
(b) The animal had escaped through a hole in the side.
(c) Blood had trickled from the airholes and chinks of the lid.
(d) There was loud whimpering heard from the box.

3. Why does the narrator believe Peggy is likely to win the girls' medal? **[1]**

(a) Peggy is the most popular girl in class.
(b) Peggy works harder than anyone else.
(c) Peggy draws better than anyone else in the room.
(d) Peggy has designed the most dresses.

4. What name does the postmaster use to sign the letter sent to Lencho? **[1]**

(a) Postmaster
(b) Lencho
(c) God
(d) Anonymous

5. In the context of the chapter, which of the following is an example of a contracted form? **[1]**

(a) can not
(b) can’t
(c) cannot
(d) I had

6. In 'The Black Aeroplane', what was the narrator's primary motivation for flying the old Dakota straight into the storm? **[1]**

(a) He wanted to test the durability of his aircraft.
(b) He was eager to reach home and enjoy a meal.
(c) He was instructed by Paris Control to take a shorter route.
(d) He failed to see the storm clouds in the dark sky.

7. Regarding the value of the disputed land, what estimate does Lomov provide for the Oxen Meadows? **[1]**

(a) They are worth five dessiatins.
(b) They are worth 40 roubles.
(c) They are worth approximately 300 roubles.
(d) They are worth the price of a set of bricks.

8. When Lomov threatens to take the dispute over the Oxen Meadows to court, what is his stated intention? **[1]**

(a) To prove that his aunt's grandmother baked bricks.
(b) To force the peasants to pay him 300 roubles.
(c) To show Natalya that the land belongs to him.
(d) To demand that the mowers are sent to the meadows.

9. When the bus travels along the canal in 'Madam Rides the Bus', what does the text describe as being on the other side of the road from the canal? **[1]**

(a) A deep ditch and green fields.
(b) Distant mountains and blue sky.
(c) A row of palm trees.
(d) A busy city street.

10. How did Wanda describe the number of dresses she owned when speaking to the girls? **[1]**

(a) She claimed to have a single dress.
(b) She claimed to have fifty dresses.
(c) She claimed to have a hundred dresses.
(d) She claimed to have dresses lined up in the yard.

11. What physical reaction does Maddie have when she recalls Wanda standing alone in the school yard? **[1]**

(a) She laughs at the memory of Wanda's claim.
(b) She rushes to Peggy's house to talk.
(c) She blinks away tears.
(d) She gazes intensely at the drawing.

12. What caused a part of Alexander’s army to settle in the land of Coorg? **[1]**

(a) They were defeated by local forces.
(b) They were seeking new trade routes.
(c) Return became impractical.
(d) They were ordered to colonize the area.

13. Which action does the author, Nelson Mandela, use to symbolize the significance of the day? **[1]**

(a) The roar of the jets over the Union Buildings.
(b) The presence of international leaders at the ceremony.
(c) The playing of two national anthems by both black and white citizens.
(d) The perfect formation of the troop carriers.

14. According to the chapter, why are contracted forms frequently found in diaries? **[1]**

(a) Diaries are written to be read by others.
(b) Writing a diary is like speaking to oneself.
(c) Diaries require formal language for accuracy.
(d) Contracted forms are required for novel writing.

15. What specific requirement did the airline impose for transporting Mij? **[1]**

(a) The box had to be placed in the cargo hold.
(b) The box could not exceed eighteen inches square.
(c) The box needed to be made of transparent material.
(d) The box had to be locked with a special metal seal.

16. How is the culture of the people of Coorg described in relation to their traditions? **[1]**

(a) They are identical to the Hindu mainstream.
(b) They are distinct from the Hindu mainstream.
(c) They follow only ancient Greek religious rites.
(d) They have no specific marriage or religious traditions.

17. Assertion (A): Grief does not follow a singular, prescribed path or method of expression. Reason (R): The process of grieving is influenced by the specific expectations of society regarding how one should recover from loss. **[1]**

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

18. Assertion (A): The young seagull experienced a temporary sensation of deafness after falling into space. Reason (R): The intensity of his terror caused his physical functions to momentarily cease. Which of the following is correct? **[1]**

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

19. Assertion (A): Lomov believes that he has reached a critical age for marriage. Reason (R): He states that he is thirty-five years old. Which of the following is correct? **[1]**

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

20. Assertion (A): When offering support to those experiencing grief, one should respect the individual's desire for privacy. Reason (R): Not every person who suffers a loss wishes to engage in conversation or accept assistance from others. **[1]**

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true but R is false.

(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION B — VERY SHORT ANSWER (20 MARKS)

Each question carries 2 marks.

21. Who is the author of the one-act play titled 'The Proposal'? **[2]**

22. How did Valli react when the conductor offered to help her board the bus, and what does this reveal about her attitude? **[2]**

23. Describe the attitude of Mijbil towards the author during the first twenty-four hours after his arrival. **[2]**

24. What must a person do to obtain peace of mind according to the Buddha's teaching, and what result does this bring? **[2]**

OR

What is the primary motive behind the marriages discussed in 'The Proposal'?

25. Describe how Mijbil played with his favourite toys. **[2]**

26. Why did the postmaster decide that answering Lencho's letter required more than just 'goodwill, ink and paper'? **[2]**

OR

Name the character who visits Stepan Chubukov to ask for his daughter's hand in marriage and describe his relationship with Chubukov.

27. What does Kisa Gotami ask for from house to house when her son dies, and why is she unsuccessful in her request? **[2]**

28. What does the phrase 'up to your eyes' signify, and in what type of situation would a person use it? **[2]**

29. Explain the significance of the action described in the following: "Maddie felt embarrassed and studied the marbles in the palm of her hand, rolling them around and saying nothing herself." **[2]**

30. What ultimatum did the mother bird give to the young bird regarding his stay on the ledge? **[2]**

SECTION C — SHORT ANSWER (30 MARKS)

Each question carries 3 marks.

31. Describe three actions of the young seagull's mother as she stood on the high hump on the plateau. **[3]**

OR

State three difficulties encountered by the narrator when trying to communicate with England by telephone.

32. Describe the process Valli could follow to return home on the same bus after reaching the town. State three points. **[3]**

33. Describe the young seagull's reaction to seeing his mother with food. State three specific details. **[3]**

34. Based on the dialogue between the narrator and his friend, what three facts did the narrator learn about the availability and behaviour of otters in the Tigris marshes? **[3]**

35. How did the baker maintain his financial records and collect payments? State three points. **[3]**

36. Explain why the bus fare of thirty paise appeared to be different values to the well-dressed man and to Valli. State three points. **[3]**

37. Explain why the Buddha discourages weeping and grieving when facing the death of a loved one. Give three points. **[3]**

OR

How did the young seagull's family members spend their time on the plateau? State any three observations.

38. What did Lencho observe throughout the morning and why? State any three points. **[3]**

39. Describe the reaction of the other children in Room Thirteen when Wanda claims to have a hundred dresses. State three points. **[3]**

OR

State three intentions Maddie had regarding Wanda upon finding her.

40. Explain the resolution Maddie reached regarding her future behaviour when witnessing others being teased. State three points. **[3]**

SECTION D — LONG ANSWER (30 MARKS)

Each question carries 5 marks.

41. Describe the physical signs that appeared in the sky and the atmospheric conditions that led Lencho to expect rain. State five distinct details. **[5]**

OR

Identify the specific sight that brought Valli unending joy and explain the nature of the bus's passengers. Provide five distinct points in your answer.

42. Peggy claims, 'I never did call her a foreigner or make fun of her name.' Discuss the significance of this specific defense in the context of Peggy's character. Explain how this choice of words reflects her limited understanding of her own behavior in three distinct points. **[5]**

43. Explain the role Sanne played in helping Anne Frank with her third essay assignment. State two ways in which this assistance was significant to the completion of the task. **[5]**

OR

Describe the methods Valli used to gather information about the bus and the people who used it. Provide five distinct points in your answer.

44. Describe Wanda Petronski's social life at school based on the text. Provide three distinct points to support your description. **[5]**

45. Explain the meaning of the phrase 'a rainbow gathering of different colours and nations' in the context of the inauguration ceremony. Include five points in your response. **[5]**

46. Describe the two playful 'stealing' customs that involve the groom at a Russian wedding reception. Explain what the groom is required to do in each instance to resolve the situation. **[5]**

OR

Peggy justifies her behavior toward Wanda by saying, 'Besides, when I was asking her about all her dresses, she probably was getting good ideas for her drawings.' Analyze how this reasoning functions as a mechanism to absolve Peggy of guilt for her past treatment of Wanda. State three points.

END OF QUESTION PAPER